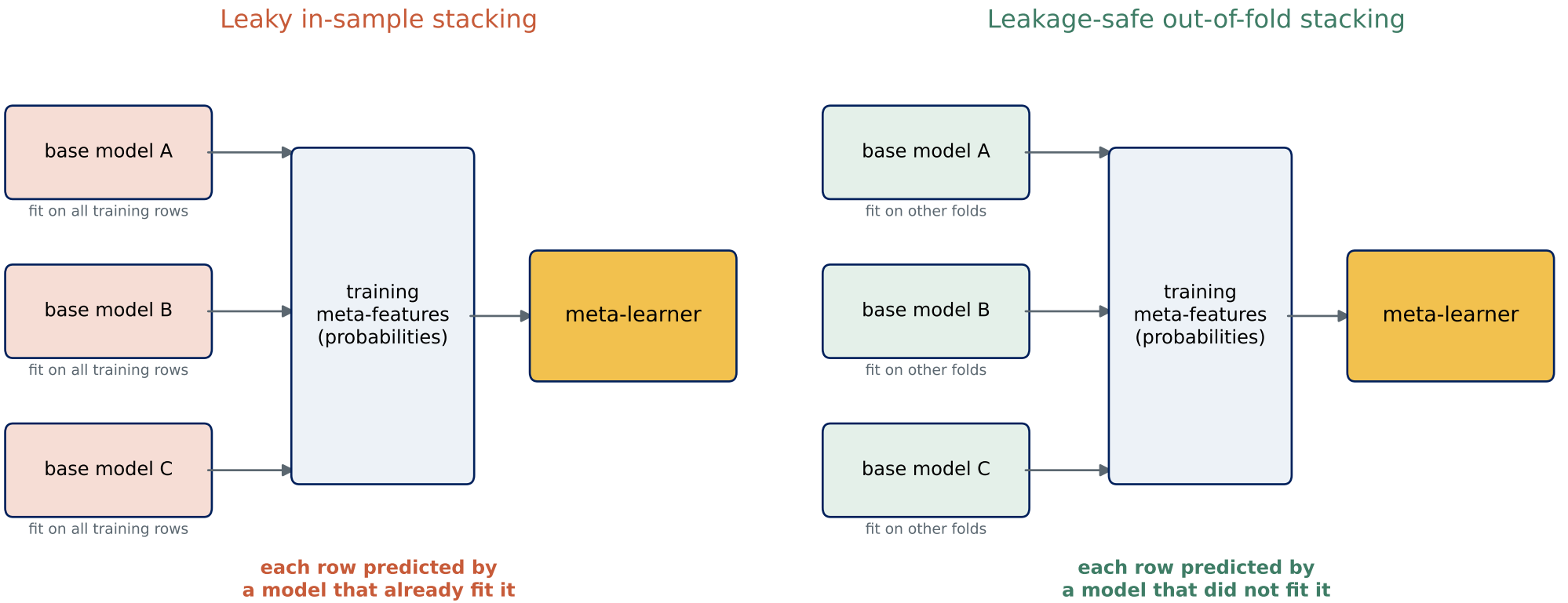The stacking boundary is a data-provenance requirement